

BUILD YOUR OWN BUSINESS CHALLENGE

\$1,000 Startup Team Project

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YOUR MISSION

Your team has \$1,000 to create a brand-new business. Work together to decide what you will sell, who your customers are, how you will spend your startup money, what jobs your business needs, and how you will advertise. At the end, your team will present the business.

Project Rules

1. Everyone must have a job and contribute.
2. Your startup spending cannot go over \$1,000.
3. The team must agree on the final business idea.
4. Be prepared to solve surprise business problems.
5. Your final presentation should explain why customers would choose your business.

Project Road Map

Session	Challenge	Finished Product
1	The Idea	Business name + product/service
2	Branding	Logo + slogan + colors
3	The Money	\$1,000 startup budget
4	Employees	Jobs + duties
5	Customers	Target customer + prices
6	Advertising	Ad/poster/commercial plan
7-8	Problem Day + Pitch	Solutions + final presentation

SESSION 1: THE BIG IDEA

Team Members: _____

Date: _____

Business Name: _____

1. What kind of business should we build?

- ☐ Food/Restaurant ☐ Clothing ☐ Lawn Care ☐ Car Care ☐ Beauty ☐ Gaming/Tech
☐ Pet Care ☐ Childcare ☐ Cleaning ☐ Construction/Repair ☐ Other: _____

2. What problem does our business solve, or what do customers need?

3. What will we sell?

Product or Service	What is it?	Possible Price

4. Our final business idea

Our business will be called: _____

We will sell/provide: _____

Customers should choose us because: _____

SESSION 2: BRAND IT

Team Members: _____

Date: _____

Business Name: _____

Business Name

Slogan

Choose Your Brand

☐ Professional ☐ Fun ☐ Sporty ☐ Luxury ☐ Family-Friendly ☐ Bold ☐ Other: _____

Main colors: _____ What do the colors say about the business?

Design Your Logo

Storefront / Business Look

Sketch what the store, truck, booth, website, uniform, or workspace might look like.

SESSION 3: THE \$1,000 STARTUP BUDGET

Team Members: _____

Date: _____

Business Name: _____

You have exactly \$1,000 available. Decide what your business needs first. You do NOT have to spend all of it.

Item Needed	Why We Need It	Cost	Running Total

TOTAL SPENT: \$ _____ MONEY LEFT: \$ _____

Money Decisions

What was the most important thing you bought? Why?

What did you decide NOT to buy so you could stay under budget?

SESSION 4: WHO DOES WHAT?

Team Members: _____

Date: _____

Business Name: _____

Assign the Team Jobs

Role	Student	Main Duties	Why this role fits
Business Manager		Keeps team organized; helps make decisions	
Money Manager		Tracks budget and prices	
Marketing Manager		Creates logo, ads and customer message	
Operations Manager		Plans supplies, workers and daily tasks	

Hiring Help

If your business grew, what other workers would you need?

Workplace Skills

- ☐ Listening ☐ Speaking clearly ☐ Following directions ☐ Teamwork ☐ Problem-solving
☐ Being on time ☐ Handling money ☐ Customer service ☐ Staying calm ☐ Asking for help

Which skill will be MOST important in your business? _____ Why?

SESSION 5: CUSTOMERS & PRICES

Team Members: _____

Date: _____

Business Name: _____

Who is your customer?

☐ Children ☐ Teens ☐ Adults ☐ Families ☐ Workers ☐ Businesses ☐ Everyone

Where would you find your customers? _____

What do your customers care about most? _____

Create Your Price List

Product/Service	Your Cost	Customer Price	Profit per Sale

Customer Service Practice

A customer says, "That costs too much." What would you say?

A customer asks a question you do not know the answer to. What should you do?

A customer is unhappy. How can your team respond professionally?

SESSION 6: ADVERTISE YOUR BUSINESS

Team Members: _____

Date: _____

Business Name: _____

Choose an Advertisement

☐ Poster/Flyer ☐ Social Media Post ☐ Radio Ad ☐ TV/Video Commercial ☐ Coupon ☐ Grand Opening Event

Your Message

Headline: _____

What are you selling? _____

Why should customers choose you? _____

Special offer: _____

Design Your Advertisement

SESSION 7: BUSINESS PROBLEM CARDS

Cut apart the cards. Draw one or more and solve the problem as a team.

EMPLOYEE CALLED OUT Your busiest day starts in one hour, and one employee calls out. What will you do? Our solution: _____ _____	BAD REVIEW A customer posts a bad online review saying your service was slow. How will you respond? Our solution: _____ _____
OVER BUDGET You discover your startup plan is \$200 over budget. What will you cut or change? Our solution: _____ _____	BROKEN EQUIPMENT A piece of equipment you need stops working. Customers are waiting. What is your plan? Our solution: _____ _____
NEW COMPETITOR A new business opens nearby and sells something similar for less money. How will you compete? Our solution: _____ _____	WRONG ORDER A customer says their order is wrong and wants it fixed immediately. What should the employee say and do? Our solution: _____ _____
SUPPLY SHORTAGE Your most popular product is almost sold out, and the next delivery is three days away. What do you do? Our solution: _____ _____	TEAM DISAGREEMENT Two employees disagree about how to handle a customer. How should the manager handle it? Our solution: _____ _____

SESSION 8: GRAND OPENING PITCH

Team Members: _____

Date: _____

Business Name: _____

Team Presentation Checklist

- ☐ Say the business name and slogan.
- ☐ Explain what the business sells.
- ☐ Show the logo/advertisement.
- ☐ Explain who the customers are.
- ☐ Share at least three prices.
- ☐ Explain how the \$1,000 was spent.
- ☐ Tell what each team member's job is.
- ☐ Explain one business problem the team solved.
- ☐ Each team member speaks or contributes.

Pitch Planner

Opening line: _____

The three BEST reasons customers should choose us are:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Closing line: _____

Team Reflection

Something I did well: _____

Something our team did well: _____

One workplace skill I practiced: _____

If we had another \$1,000, I would: _____

TEACHER / PROVIDER QUICK GUIDE

Suggested use: one 30-minute session at a time. Keep documentation tied to the single Pre-ETS service actually addressed in that session.

Session	Likely Skill Area	Easy Facilitation Prompt
1 Idea	Job Exploration / Workplace Readiness	What kind of work happens in this business?
2 Branding	Workplace Readiness	How does a business communicate with customers?
3 Budget	Workplace Readiness	What is a need versus a want?
4 Jobs	Job Exploration	What job would you choose and why?
5 Customers	Workplace Readiness	How should an employee treat a customer?
6 Advertising	Workplace Readiness	How do we communicate clearly and professionally?
7 Problems	Self-Advocacy / Workplace Readiness	How can you speak up, ask for help, and solve the problem?
8 Pitch	Self-Advocacy	How can you explain your idea and contribute to the group?

Participation Notes

Jaden:

Haley:

Delmont:

Max Dane:

Next Session Plan
